the Meister's arms were crossed at his chest, and he was shaking his head, she guessed they were arguing. Maybe they, too, were on edge the way everyone was after the increase in Allied bombings all over the country. Rumors circulated that many cities had been destroyed, with tens of thousands dead. The women in the barracks were frightened by what they'd heard. *If they want to close down the factories by bombing the workers, then might they bomb Glashütte too?* Léa tried to reassure the women that Glashütte was too small. The Allies targeted large cities like Berlin and Hamburg. Rose remained anxious for André, who had yet to arrive.

"Fräulein Cotillard, may I have a word with you?" the Lagerführer called her over.

Léa stiffened. Had the Meister seen her slip the ampoule into Maria's apron? She wasn't allowed to take medicine outside of the sick bay. In fact, she shouldn't be doing most of what she did at the sick bay. Over the last few months, Josef had taught her how to monitor a patient's vital signs, such as pulse and respiratory rate, clean wounds, apply dressings, and administer simple injections.

"Yes?" Léa braced for the worst.

"Come, let's walk together. I've noticed that you spend a lot of your time at the sick bay."

She didn't want to get Josef in trouble. "I only try to help."

"Indeed, well, that's why I want to talk with you."

She swallowed, hoping none of the patients had reported her.

Stepping outside, she felt the last of the sunlight on her face. The winter months' short days were the hardest to get through, especially as coal and gas shortages meant there was no place to go to escape the cold—all supplies had been diverted to the Wehrmacht. Every day was a constant battle to stay warm.

"With Herr Reinhardt's approval, I'm reassigning you to the sick bay."

Léa stopped. "I won't be working at the factory anymore?"

"Not for the foreseeable future."

There had to be some catch or trick. "I don't understand."

"Dr. Capek needs the support. I received a telegram today about a group of Eastern workers arriving by train at week's end." Reaching into her dress pocket, she removed a linen cloth and dabbed her nose with it. "I've been warned that they may not be in good condition. You will support Dr. Capek